



SCHUYLKILL RIVER GREENWAYS

Multiple Ways to Interact with Nature

Published by Llyan Johnson

Looking for things to do? Take a tour, explore, hike, bike, jog, canoe, kayak, tube, fish, camp, shop, and so much more. With the 128-mile Schuylkill River as its spine, our Schuylkill River National and State Heritage Area is alive with a remarkable diversity of historic, recreational and cultural attractions. Along “the Revolutionary River,” visitors can shadow the birth of our nation from the cobblestone streets and fabled landmarks of old Philadelphia to the huts and hollows of Valley Forge. Upstream you’ll find a wealth of historic places, quaint river towns, abundant parks and access points to the river and trails, and year-round festivals and activities. There’s always something new to discover. The cultural offerings in the Schuylkill River Heritage Area are almost immeasurable. World class art museums, public art, cultural centers and performing arts venues are around almost every turn. Whether your preference is a rail-trail with a gentle grade, or rolling hills and picturesque valleys, the Heritage Area has roads and trails that provide wonderful bicycling experiences. For those who want to commune with nature and spend a night or two out of doors, there are plenty of camping facilities throughout the Schuylkill River Heritage Area. In this section you’ll find information about where you camp, camping safety and ethics, and resources you can contact for further information. The Schuylkill River Heritage Area is home to a vast number of bird species, both native and migratory. There are numerous sites and facilities where you can view and learn about birds. The Heritage Area is especially noted for its location along the Kittatiny Flyway, one of the nation’s most significant migratory bird routes. The Schuylkill River Heritage Area is criss-crossed by a network of trails that connect parks, gardens, and neighborhoods with each other and their environment. Those seeking to get out and walk will find ample opportunities to stretch their legs in all parts of the Heritage Area.



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Schuylkill River Sojourn

☀ June 14-20, 2025

☀ Schuylkill Haven to Philly

The Schuylkill River Sojourn is the annual 112-mile guided kayak/canoe trip that begins where the water trail does, in Schuylkill Haven, PA. The trip ends seven days later at the end of the iconic Boathouse Row in Philadelphia, just miles from where the Schuylkill connects with the Delaware River. The Sojourn includes meals, camping, gear storage, shuttles, and more. Now our signature event, the first trip was held as a fundraiser for what was then known as the Schuylkill Greenways Association. The Schuylkill River Sojourn has become the stuff of legend and a destination for paddlers across the country and for good reason.



A guided paddle with meals and camping included!

New Bridge Completed in 2028

Published by Jayden Smith

POTTSTOWN, PA — Officials estimate the work to reconstruct the historic Pottstown bridge, connecting Montgomery and Chester counties, will take three years, they said during groundbreaking ceremonies held Monday. The 800-foot long Keim Street Bridge was built in 1935 and connects Pottstown with North Coventry Township on the other side of the Schuylkill River. “Soon, a brand new bridge will rise in its place to restore this vital connection for residents, businesses, and travelers,” county officials said. “The reconstruction is scheduled to be completed in 2028.” Structural deficiencies in the eight span, steel-pony truss forced the bridge to shutter. The new bridge will feature 11-foot wide driving lanes in both directions, four-foot wide shoulders, and a six-foot wide sidewalk. The \$20 million project is funded with 80 percent federal funds, 15 percent state funds, and 5 percent Montgomery County funds. Montgomery County commissioners were joined by State Reps. Joe Ciresi and Paul Friel, as well as Pottstown borough council president Dan Weand, at Monday’s groundbreaking. Please be advised that these construction activities may temporarily affect users of the Schuylkill River Trail along Industrial Highway—with the most significant impacts anticipated through 2026. A small trail detour will be in place during this period, and there will be intermittent closures. For your safety, all trail users are strongly advised not to enter the construction site.



Use Caution on the Trail During Hunting Season

Published by Rosemary Keane

Hunting season has officially started and will remain active during the cold weather months. Since some sections of the Schuylkill River Trail run through wooded areas where hunting is permitted, take precautions when you’re out on the trail. Hunters are not permitted to hunt on the actual trail but may use the trail to get to permitted hunting areas. Wear bright orange so you are visible to hunters. When walking or jogging carry items that make noise such as bells. Beware that white hats and mittens can resemble a deer’s tail, and that red and green can look brown in dusky light. All 20 of Pennsylvania’s state forests and 97 of the 121 state parks are open to hunting during established hunting seasons.